



NEW ZEALAND

Capital city: Wellington
Area: 103,737 sq miles (268,680 sq km)
Population: 3,900,000
Official language: English, Maori
Major religions: Christian 62%, other 38%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: New Zealand dollar
Adult literacy rate: 99%
Life expectancy: 78 years
People per doctor: 225
Televisions: 508 per 1,000 people

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SITUATED ABOUT 932 MILES (1,500 KM) from Australia, New Zealand consists of two large islands – North and South Island – and several smaller ones. The North Island has a warm, mild climate and is volcanically active. The South Island is colder, with glaciers, high mountain peaks, and forests. From 1840 to 1907 New Zealand was a British colony, but it gained full independence in 1947. The original inhabitants, the Maoris, still make up about 12 percent of the population. New Zealand is a wealthy and progressive country, and was the first in the world to give women the right to vote.



FARMING

Large areas of grass and a warm, damp climate make New Zealand ideal for farming, especially raising sheep and cattle. There are about 40 million sheep (about 10 for every one person) and 10 million cattle. Around half of New Zealand's exports are agricultural products. The country is one of the world's leading exporters of wool, frozen meat, and dairy products, such as butter and cheese.



ENERGY

More than 60 percent of New Zealand's electricity comes from hydroelectric plants, like the Clyde Dam on the South Island, which harness the power of its rushing rivers. New Zealand does not use nuclear power. This, together with its small population and lack of heavy industry, make it one of the world's least polluted countries. New Zealand is very proud of its "clean green" image.



PEOPLE AND CITIES

There are only about 3.9 million people in New Zealand – just over half the population of London or Paris. Nearly three-quarters of New Zealanders live on the North Island, and most of them live in the cities. Wellington, shown here, is New Zealand's capital city.

